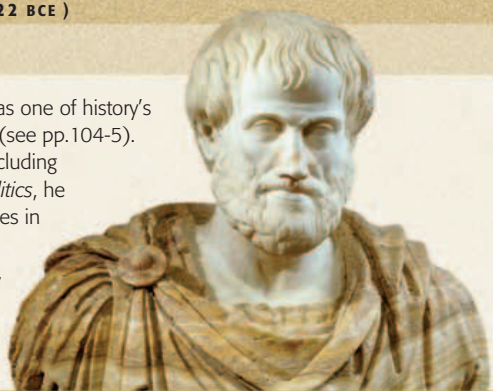


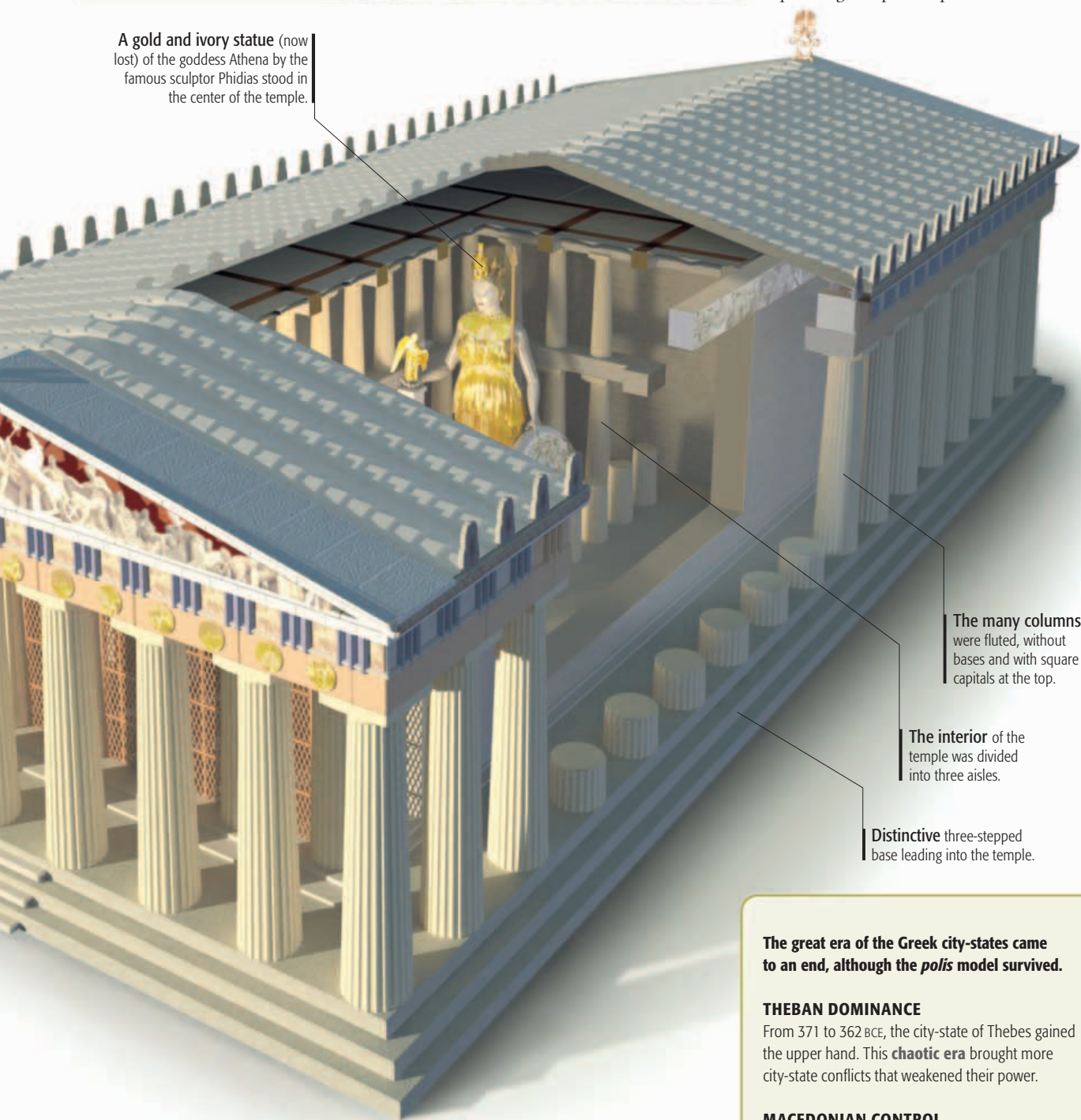
GREEK PHILOSOPHER (384–322 BCE)

ARISTOTLE

Born in northern Greece, Aristotle was one of history's greatest philosophers and scientists (see pp.104-5). He wrote on a variety of subjects, including government. In his famous work, *Politics*, he analyzed many of the Greek city-states in an exploration of what might be the best form of government. In general, he had a great respect for the *polis* as a good way to govern and to make the most of people's talents.



A gold and ivory statue (now lost) of the goddess Athena by the famous sculptor Phidias stood in the center of the temple.



The many columns were fluted, without bases and with square capitals at the top.

The interior of the temple was divided into three aisles.

Distinctive three-stepped base leading into the temple.

The great era of the Greek city-states came to an end, although the *polis* model survived.

THEBAN DOMINANCE

From 371 to 362 BCE, the city-state of Thebes gained the upper hand. This **chaotic era** brought more city-state conflicts that weakened their power.

MACEDONIAN CONTROL

In 338 BCE, the Macedonian King Philip II <<96–97 defeated the Greeks and formed the **League of Corinth** to support his own imperial plans.

that were later tackled by Plato and Aristotle (see left), and the thriving Athens that emerged from the Greek victory against Persia in the 4th century BCE saw its Acropolis rebuilt and the great Parthenon temple (below) completed.

Sparta and Corinth

Athens's great rival, Sparta, had a dual kingship from two royal lines—these kings ruled concurrently. Later, this rule was tempered by a council of aristocrats and an assembly of citizens (the *Homoioi*)—a society of equal male citizens willing to take arms for their state. Sparta also differed from the other Greek states in relying heavily on a serf population known as *helots*. In the 5th century BCE, a small, council-elected body called the *ephorate* came into being. Conceived to oversee government processes, they eventually seized power for themselves and sidelined the monarchy for a time. Sparta was famed for its army and military training.

Another powerful *polis*, Corinth, commanded a strong strategic position geographically on the narrow strip of land connecting mainland Greece.

The struggle for supremacy

The rise of hoplite warfare (see pp.116–17) in the 7th century BCE was central to the rise of the city-states. As the use of the phalanx formation became widespread (see pp.114–15), citizens who fought for their states expected some political say in return. Rivalry between city-states was constant, particularly between Athens and Sparta. Some events brought the states together, such as the Panhellenic games, which included the Olympic Games, and religious festivals. The city-states combined forces against the Persians in the 5th century (see pp.92–93), in an alliance effectively led by Sparta (although Athens was later dominant). Victory brought confidence and a sense of identity and unity.

AFTER

THE CITY OF ROME

Rome grew in power 106–107 >> and ruled over an empire using some of the ancient Greek models.

THE MIDDLE AGES AND THE RENAISSANCE

The 11th century CE saw the rise of **Italian city-states** such as Venice and Pisa. By the 13th–15th centuries, other examples flourished at Florence, Padua, Hamburg, and Flanders. The Renaissance rediscovery of **classical ideas and learning in western Europe** brought Plato and Aristotle's ideas on government to the fore 250–53 >>.

The Parthenon

This breathtaking marble temple was built on Athens' acropolis between 447 and 432 BCE, on a wave of euphoria that engulfed the Athenians after their defeat of Persia. It was dedicated to the city's patron goddess, Athena.